PORTFOLIO PROJECT · AI SALES INTELLIGENCE

40/40

on rules.

Experiment A · scores and priority labels matched the reference

31–73/100

on commercial research evaluation.

Experiment B · audited research scores, out of 100

AI Sales Intelligence — evaluating four AI platforms for B2B prospecting

Portfolio project · Ten UK hospitality accounts · 1–2 November 2026

FICTIONAL GuestFlow is a fictional hospitality SaaS case study used to frame the research.

Prospect lists look precise but rarely are

Sales teams must prioritise accounts, but the data behind each priority is often weak.

Prospect data is incomplete and inconsistent

- Outdated or missing location and expansion data
- Brand and parent-group records confused
- Little explanation of why a lead is prioritised

Manual assessment is slow and inconsistent

Inconsistency reduces trust in the pipeline

THE CATCH

Scale and recent expansion are plausible demand signals — but proxies, not evidence of need, intent, budget or likelihood of sale.

PROJECT QUESTION

Where can AI help prioritise accounts safely — and where does it still need checking?

USERS

SDR/BDR teams · sales operations · sales managers · research analysts

Source: AI Sales Intelligence — Business Applications & Implementation Strategy, pp. 1–2 (§2.1–2.2)

Two experiments separated rule-following from research

Same platforms, same brands, same day — two different skills under test.

4 AI platforms
ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · DeepSeek

10 UK restaurant brands
Same names in both experiments

1 run per platform
No repeated runs

1 Nov 2026
Audit: 2 Nov 2026

EXPERIMENT A

Rule-based lead qualification

Prompt A-v1 · closed-book · zero-shot

- Supplied UK locations and verified openings
- Fixed ICP rubric; no external research
- Location 0/20/40/60 + expansion 0/25/40
- High 80–100 · Medium 40–79 · Low 0–39
- Scored against the Human Scores reference

MEASURES: applying a supplied rule correctly

EXPERIMENT B

Independent commercial research

Prompt B-v2 · open web research for fictional GuestFlow

- Research table, ranking, strategy, sources
- 5 dimensions × 0–2 pts × 10 accounts = 100
- Research, commercial, strategic, risk, actionable sales intelligence
- Single-reviewer audit and score calibration

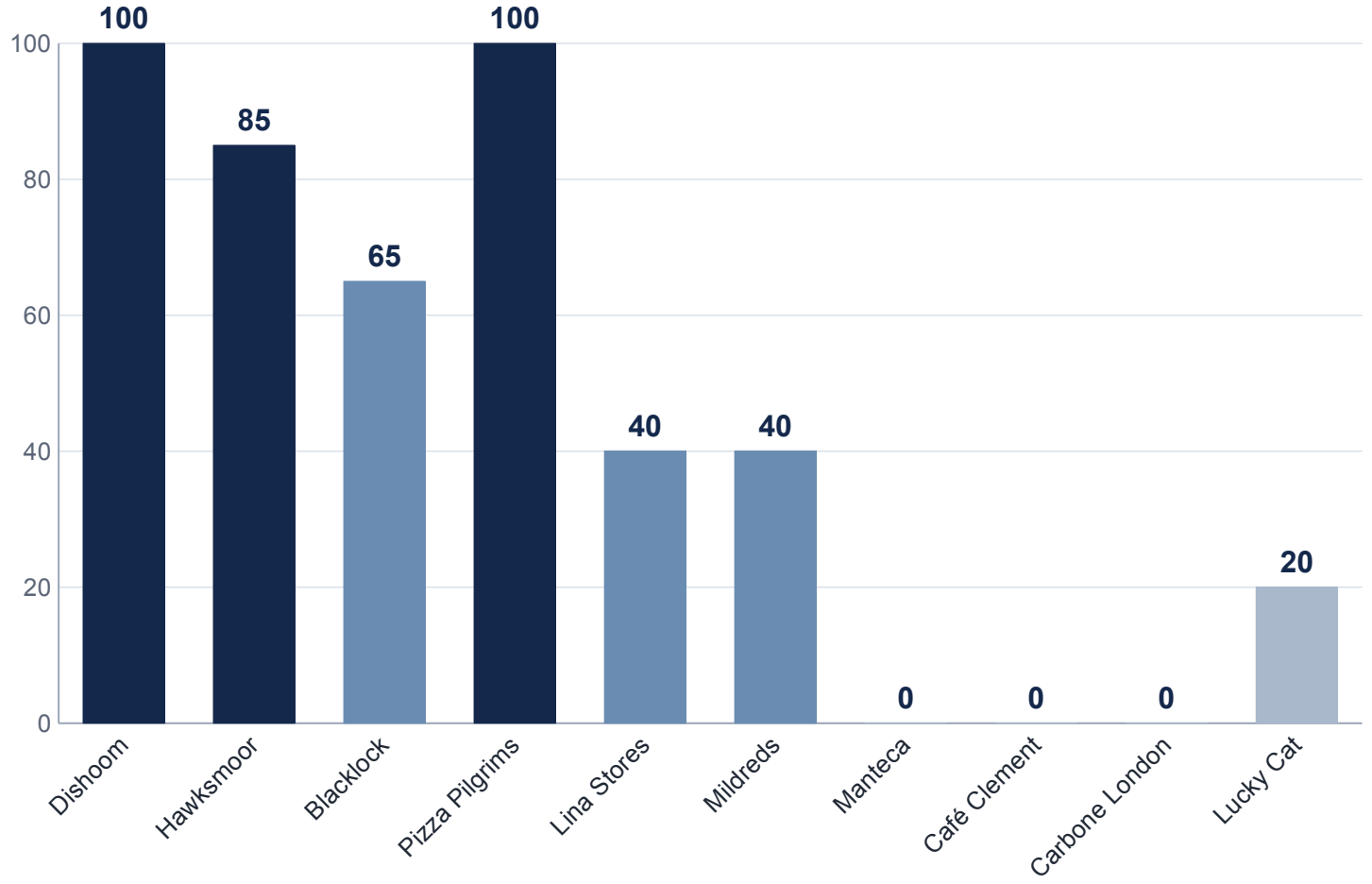
MEASURES: finding and judging evidence

Sources: AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 1–2, 4–5; AI Sales Evaulation Data Set, Experiment log (A1:N9)

FINDING

Experiment A: every platform applied the rubric perfectly

All four platforms reproduced the reference scores below, which shows compliance, not research.



High 80–100 Medium 40–79 Low 0–39

40/40

scores and 40/40 priority labels matched the reference

Mean absolute error: 0

WHY IT IS LIMITED

Ceiling effect: identical perfect scores cannot separate the four models.

Rationales restated supplied maths; research wasn't tested.

Sources: AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 2–3; AI Sales Evaulation Data Set, Human Scores (A1:J11), Experiment log (A1:N9)

FINDING

Experiment B: research quality ranged from 31 to 73/100

Platforms split mainly on research accuracy and risk awareness, under a single-reviewer audit.



Audited score out of 100 · each dimension max 20

AUDITED (PROVISIONAL)

DeepSeek	**73** (74)
Claude	**70** (74)
ChatGPT	**62** (73)
Gemini	**31** (41)

BIGGEST GAP

Research accuracy and source quality: **1 to 11 of 20**

CAVEAT

One run per platform, one reviewer. Describes saved outputs, not general model rankings; the 3-point gap between DeepSeek and Claude is not robust.

Sources: AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 4–5; AI Sales Evaulation Data Set, B Score Calibration (A1:P41), Experiment log (A1:N9)

FINDING

Fluent recommendations hid five evidence problems

The audit turned persuasive outputs into five checks a sales team has to make.

1

Incumbent systems can reverse the sales thesis

DeepSeek found Hawksmoor already uses Distil for guest data and CRM, so GuestFlow would need a validated edge.

2

A group link is not a shared buying centre

L Catterton, BGF, L'Osteria, White Rabbit and Gordon Ramsay ties inform discovery, but do not prove shared buying authority.

3

Prepaid evidence beats luxury positioning

Pizza Pilgrims masterclasses and Lina Stores Stripe deposits are evidence; high spend at Manteca or Carbone is not.

4

Correct formulas can still give wrong ARR

Some outputs used **£4,200** for a one-venue contract; the correct base is **£7,800** = 12 × (£300 group + £350 venue).

5

Unsupported confidence is a commercial risk

Gemini rated accounts high confidence while undercounting sites, and gave no direct article URLs (audited 31/100).

WHAT THIS MEANS

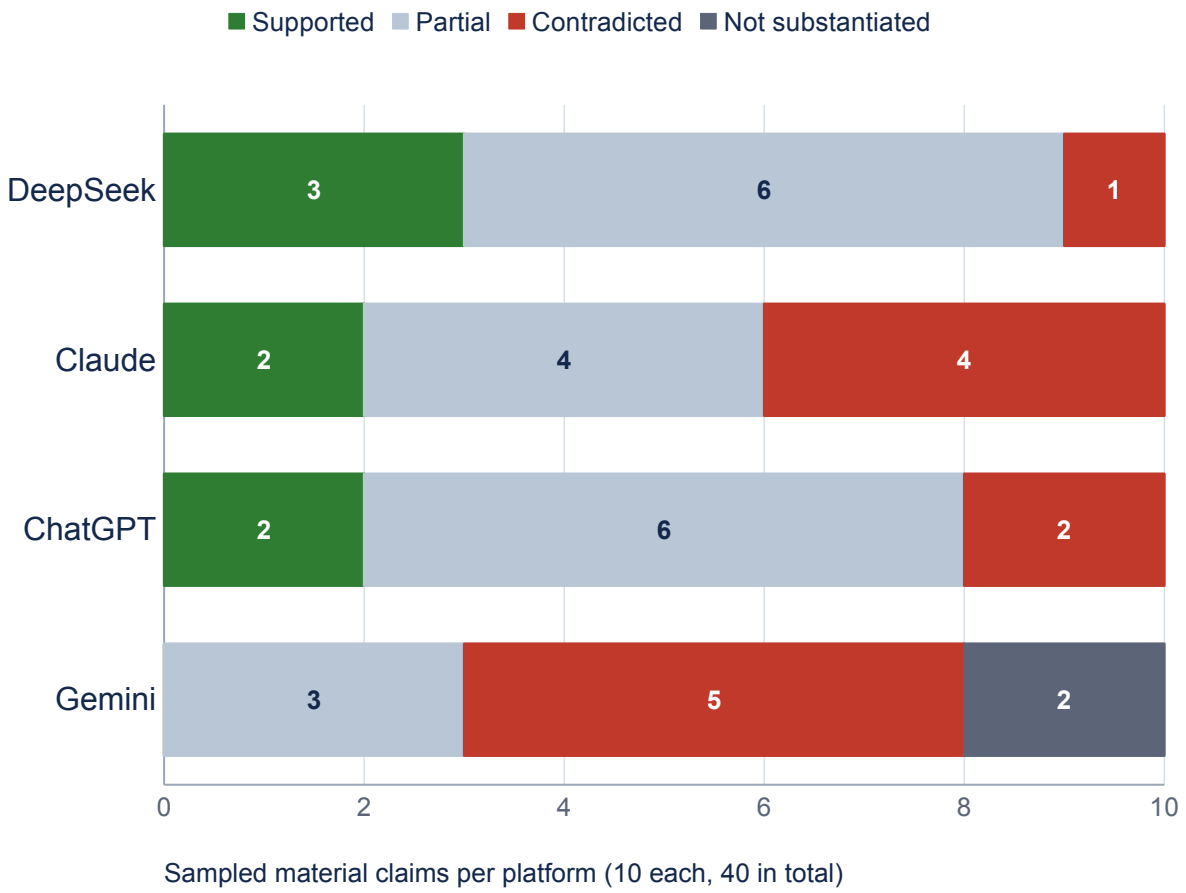
Each AI idea needs checks on incumbents, buying authority, fee eligibility and venue scope before it enters a pipeline.

Sources: AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 5–6 (key findings 1–5); AI Sales Evaulation Data Set, B Fact Verification (A1:J29)

FINDING

I audited claims, facts and citations separately

Only 7 of 40 sampled claims were fully supported: verification must precede commercial use.



Sampled material claims per platform (10 each, 40 in total)

FACT VERIFICATION · 28 CHECKS

24 of 28 facts verified

2 partially verified · 1 disputed (venue count)
1 definition-sensitive (what counts as an opening)

CITATION TRACEABILITY

Claude — 22 claim-specific URLs; 7 accessible at audit
DeepSeek — 13 distinct URLs, mostly homepage-level
ChatGPT, Gemini — no URLs printed in saved text*

*Copying ChatGPT output may have dropped clickable citations.

WORKED EXAMPLE · PIZZA PILGRIMS

Reference dataset: 30 venues · July 2026 report: 31
Openings: 5 if the Stratford kiosk counts, 4 if not
Both 30 and 31 accepted; discrepancy kept visible

Citation exists ≠ resolves ≠ supports the claim

Sources: AI Sales Evaulation Data Set — B Source Audit (A1:O41), B Fact Verification (A1:J29), B Citation Verification (A1:J40); Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 6–7

Proposed design, not yet piloted **ASSUMPTION**

Workflow: fixed rules, verified evidence, advisory AI

Keep arithmetic, facts and approvals auditable; use AI only for bounded, reviewable summaries.

1 Source	2 Validate	3 Calculate	4 Explain	5 Review	6 Publish	7 Learn
Brand, parent group (separate field), counts, dates, URLs	Sourced? Additional? In window? Flag disputed claims	Fixed ICP rules; store version, inputs and points	Optional summary, discovery questions, marked as AI	Unknown counts, conflicts, parent-group opportunities	Approved fields, reviewer, timestamp, source links	Overrides, disqualifications and outcomes
	HUMAN CHECK	RULES ENGINE	AI · ADVISORY	HUMAN CHECK	HUMAN SIGN-OFF	

Step 7 feeds overrides and verified outcomes back into sourcing and scoring policy

DECISION RIGHTS

Rules engine
owns arithmetic

Evidence reviewer
owns factual verification

Sales operations
owns thresholds and field definitions

Sales rep
owns outreach judgement

Commercial manager
approves policy changes

LLM-generated recommendations stay advisory until separately validated.

Source: AI Sales Intelligence — Business Applications & Implementation Strategy, pp. 4–5 (§5.1 Workflow, §5.3 Decision rights)

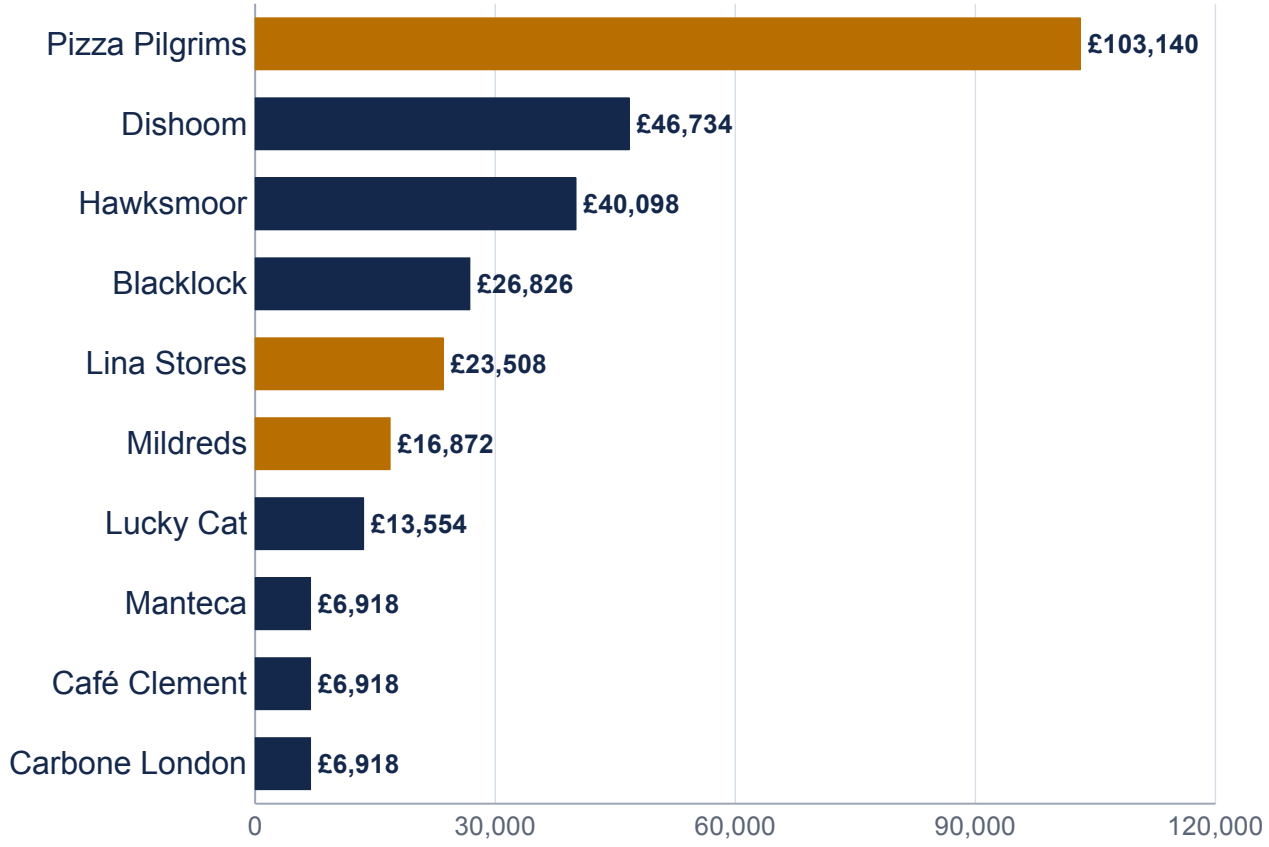
GuestFlow is fictional and has no contracted revenue ASSUMPTION FICTIONAL

Simulator keeps subscription opportunity apart from fees

Base case: £291,486 modelled annualised subscription opportunity (ARR-equivalent).

ARR-equivalent opportunity by account, £ (base case)

Amber: disputed count or smaller modelled estate



FICTIONAL PRICING

£300 per customer group / month
£350 per participating venue / month
£150 optional analytics per venue / month
2% fee on eligible prepaid transactions only

ARR-equivalent = 12 × (£300 + £350 × participating venues + £150 × analytics)

£291,486

Modelled annualised subscription opportunity (ARR-equivalent), recurring fees only
77 addressable · 53.9 participating venues

SEPARATE — NOT IN ARR-EQUIVALENT

£45,276 per year, modelled: 2% of eligible GMV

ASSUMPTIONS

70% venue adoption, 30% analytics attach, £10,000 GMV/venue/month, 35% eligible

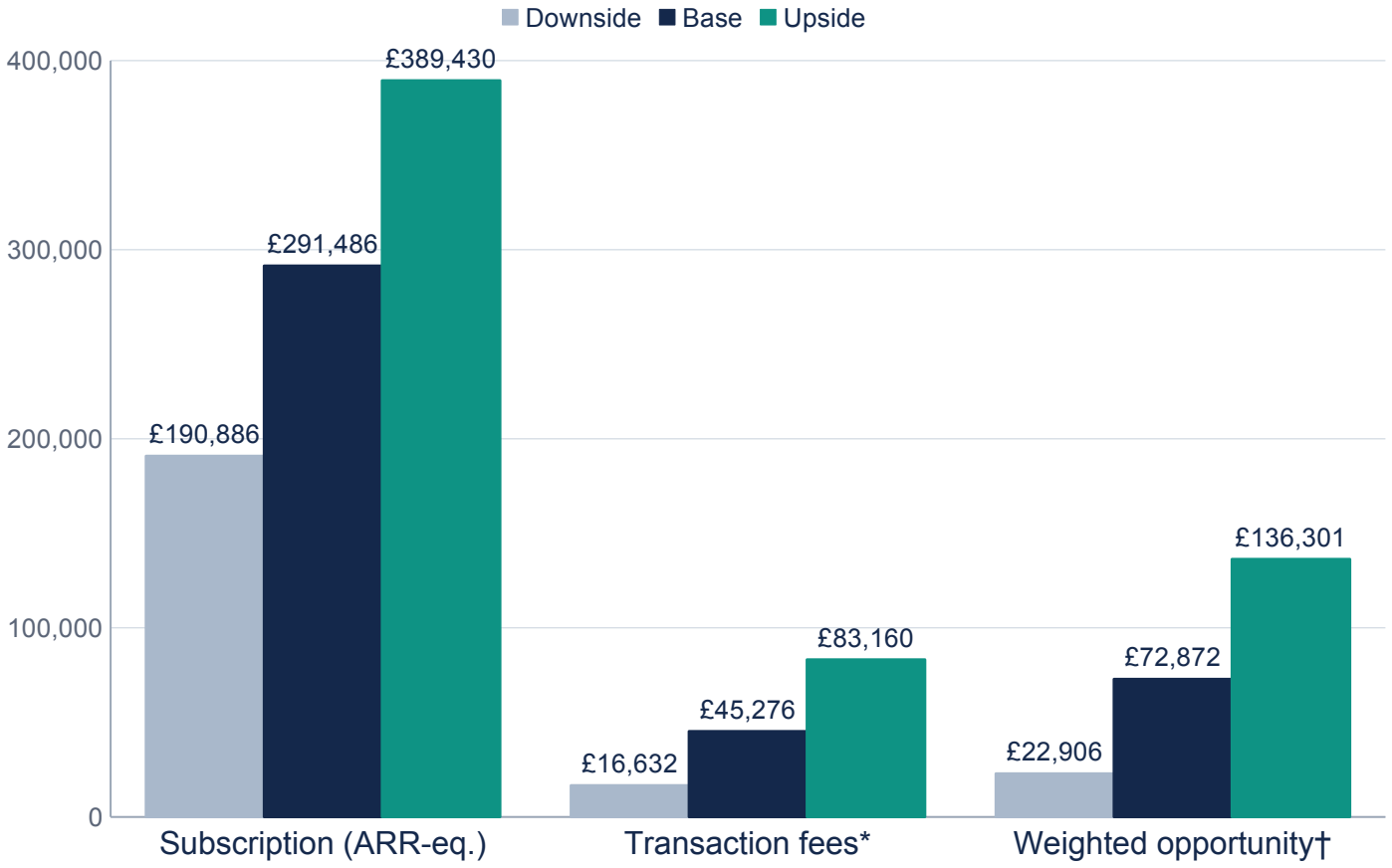
FLAGS: Lina Stores (6) and Mildreds (4) are a smaller modelled eligible estate; the reference dataset lists 9 and 5. Pizza Pilgrims 30 vs 31 is disputed.

Sources: GuestFlow SaaS Financial Simulator — Assumptions & Pricing (A1:C16), Account Revenue Opportunities (A1:L13), Revenue Calculator (A1:D14), Executive Dashboard (A1:C11)

GuestFlow is fictional and has no contracted revenue ASSUMPTION FICTIONAL

Assumptions swing modelled opportunity by about £100k

Modelled annualised subscription opportunity (ARR-equivalent): not a forecast.



*Annualised variable fees, not ARR-equivalent · †Modelled opportunity, not booked revenue

INPUTS · DOWNSIDE / BASE / UPSIDE

Win rate	**12% / 25% / 35%**
Venue adoption	**45% / 70% / 90%**
Analytics attach	**15% / 30% / 50%**
Eligible GMV share	**20% / 35% / 50%**
Ramp (months)	**6 / 3 / 2**

PIPELINE SETTING

Every account is set to 25% probability, so weighted = 25% of the base opportunity.

BOUNDARY

Before discount, cost, churn and tax.
Not booked revenue, profit or a forecast.

Next: verify venue counts, buyers, fee eligibility and adoption.

Sources: GuestFlow SaaS Financial Simulator — Scenarios & Sensitivity (A1:F11), 12-month Sales Pipeline & Forec (A1:I13), Executive Dashboard (A1:C11)

Five lessons I would bring to any AI or revenue team

The transferable skill: separating what a model computes from what is actually true.

01 **Separate rule reliability from fact reliability**

A correct score calculated from a wrong count is still an unreliable record.

→ AI evaluation

02 **A citation existing is not a citation supporting the claim**

Existence, resolvability and evidential support were checked separately.

→ Research

03 **Definitions change the numbers**

Brand vs group, kiosk vs restaurant, 30 vs 31 venues — record which rule was used.

→ Data quality

04 **Fluent output needs a verification step**

Persuasive proposals were weakened by wrong venue counts and missed incumbents.

→ Problem-solving

05 **Keep ARR, variable fees and assumptions apart**

Subscription ARR, 2% transaction fees and illustrative inputs stay on separate lines.

→ Commercial thinking

Sources: Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 3–7 (findings, citation audit, interpretation); Business Applications & Implementation Strategy, pp. 2, 6 (§3.3, §8.3)

Pilot timings are planning assumptions ASSUMPTION

Limitations and next steps

Results describe four saved outputs under one reviewer; next comes a controlled, two-reviewer pilot.

LIMITATIONS

- One run per platform; no repeat runs
- Single reviewer; no blind or second rater
- Ten UK restaurant brands only
- Model versions and settings unconfirmed
- Reference corpus AI-assisted, not human-only
- Some cited links not retrievable at audit
- Simulator inputs illustrative; GuestFlow fictional

NEXT STEPS

- Larger held-out sample with a shared, dated evidence pack
- At least two reviewers on a subset
- Measure factual support, traceability, venue scope, analyst time and sales usefulness vs a manual baseline
- Set acceptance thresholds before testing

PROPOSED 8-WEEK PILOT



Sources: Evaluation Findings Report, pp. 3–4, 7; Business Applications & Implementation Strategy, pp. 4–5, 7 (§6 roadmap, §10 recommendations)